

River-Class Destroyer: Availability of Cost Data

I'm sorry, but **estimating the cost of every individual component in the River-class destroyer based on publicly available data is extremely difficult**. Very few suppliers disclose unit prices, and most contracts for the program are bundled into larger packages that include design, integration and support. For example, the Canadian government's implementation contract for the first three ships is worth **CA\$8 billion** ¹, and the total cost for construction and delivery of those three ships is **CA\$22.2 billion** ². This overarching figure includes hull fabrication, propulsion, weapons, sensors, systems integration and other services, but it does **not provide a line-item breakdown**.

Examples of disclosed contract values

A few contract values have been made public, offering rough indications of costs for certain subsystems. These figures are illustrative, not comprehensive:

Subsystem	Publicly disclosed contract value	Source
Visual Surveillance System & IPMS (L3Harris)	> CA\$170 million for the first three ships ($\approx$ CA\$57 million per ship) ³ .	Irving Shipbuilding release ³
ASIST helicopter handling system (Curtiss-Wright)	US\$25 million contract for three ships ($\approx$ US\$8 million per ship) ⁴ .	Curtiss-Wright press release ⁴
Fin stabiliser design (Kongsberg)	CA\$6.7 million contract for non-retractable fin stabiliser design ⁵ .	CanadaBuys listing ⁵
Engine intake/exhaust & IR suppression (W.R. Davis)	> CA\$30 million ⁶ .	ShipsforCanada article ⁶
Flexible hose systems (Patlon)	> CA\$30 million ⁷ .	Patlon announcement ⁷
Sensor integration (MDA Space)	CA\$60 million for delivery and integration of sensor systems for the first three ships ⁸ ⁹ .	MDA release ⁸ ⁹
SPY-7 radar (Lockheed Martin)	US\$104.6 million contract; number of radars not specified 【181464457829690†L59-L81】.	U.S. DoD announcement 【181464457829690†L59-L81】

Why a full breakdown isn't possible

1. **Bundled contracts:** Most equipment is purchased under bundled contracts covering design, production, integration, training and support. Suppliers rarely release unit prices for individual items.
2. **Foreign Military Sales:** Weapons and sensor systems such as the SPY-7 radar, AN/SLQ-32 electronic warfare suite, Standard Missile 2, ESSM Block II and Tomahawk are procured via U.S. Foreign Military Sales. These agreements combine equipment and services for multiple units, and individual line items are not publicly disclosed.
3. **Commercial sensitivity:** Companies treat the prices of high-technology equipment as proprietary. Detailed cost breakdowns might be available to government auditors but are not released to the public.
4. **Variability and integration costs:** Prices vary depending on ship-specific configurations, integration work and support packages. For example, a 2003 forecast put the cost of a Rolls-Royce MT30 generator set at **US\$12–13 million** ¹⁰, but modern marine packages include additional modules and integration that likely increase the cost.

Conclusion

While the overall River-class destroyer program is valued at more than **CA\$22 billion** for the first three ships, **publicly available data does not allow precise cost attribution to individual components**. Only a handful of contract values have been released, offering hints at the magnitude of certain systems. Any attempt to estimate the costs of propulsion equipment, weapon systems, sonar suites, radar or the combat management system beyond these examples would be speculative and could misrepresent the program's finances.

¹ ² Government of Canada announces contract award for the construction of the River-class destroyers for the Royal Canadian Navy - Canada.ca

<https://www.canada.ca/en/department-national-defence/news/2025/03/government-of-canada-announces-contract-award-for-the-construction-of-the-river-class-destroyers-for-the-royal-canadian-navy.html>

³ Irving Shipbuilding awards L3Harris VSS work on Canada's River-class destroyers - Naval Today

<https://www.navaltoday.com/2025/09/29/irving-shipbuilding-awards-l3harris-vss-work-on-canadas-river-class-destroyers/>

⁴ Curtiss Wright Awarded 25M Contract To Provide Aircraft Handling Systems AND Support FOR Royal Canadian Navy River Class Destroyers | EMS | Curtiss-Wright

<https://electro-mechanicalsystems.curtisswright.com/news/news-details/2025/Curtiss-Wright-Awarded-25M-Contract-To-Provide-Aircraft-Handling-Systems-And-Support-For-Royal-Canadian-Navy-River-Class-Destroyers>

⁵ KONGSBERG MARITIME CANADA LTD (W8482-156502/002/ML~009) - Contract History | CanadaBuys

<https://canadabuy.ca/en/tender-opportunities/contract-history/w8482-156502/002/ml-009>

⁶ Ottawa's W.R. Davis Engineering awarded \$30-million supply chain contract to support the River-class destroyer project (Canadian Surface Combatant) for Canada's Navy - Irving Shipbuilding

<https://shipsforcanada.ca/our-stories/ottawas-w-r-davis-engineering-awarded-30-million-supply-chain-contract-to-support-the-river-class-destroyer-project-canadian-surface-combatant-for-canadas-navy>

⁷ Patlon Secures \$30M Contract with Irving Shipbuilding for River-Class Destroyer Project. - Patlon

<https://patlon.com/patlon-secures-30m-contract-with-irving-shipbuilding-for-river-class-destroyer-project/>

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<https://mda.space/article/mda-awarded-first-production-contract-canadian-surface-combatant>

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